Dear Halden Pay Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role. Across nine years in data engineering, I have built and operated production platforms for e-commerce, logistics and payments, with a focus on dependable pipelines, clear data contracts and trusted warehouses. Halden Pay's focus on a shared platform and reusable frameworks is a strong match for the work I have done.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own the platform ingestion layer across around 140 Airflow DAGs and have helped improve reliability and speed across the warehouse. I migrated more than 400 transformations to dbt, adding tests, documentation and incremental models; the nightly build fell from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I also introduced data contracts that reduced broken-pipeline incidents from about nine per month to two, and built a Kafka streaming pipeline processing around 30 million events daily. These projects have involved operating production systems, improving data quality and taking responsibility for problems through the on-call rotation. This work strengthened shared platform capabilities rather than creating one-off pipelines, giving downstream teams more reliable, reusable foundations. My work combines Python and SQL across large-scale batch processing, warehouse transformation, CDC, and production pipeline optimisation.

My earlier work at Kovalent Pay is especially relevant to Halden Pay's business. I built PySpark reconciliation jobs on AWS EMR to process around 1.2 TB of daily files, reducing month-end manual reconciliation from about three days to four hours, and designed a Redshift cloud data warehouse using dimensional modelling and a star schema, with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk. I have also contributed fixes and tests to an open-source Airflow provider. Although my production experience is with AWS and Snowflake rather than Google Cloud, it includes comparable cloud data platforms: AWS EMR, S3 and Glue for large-scale processing, and Snowflake as a managed cloud data warehouse. My experience is with AWS and Snowflake rather than Google Cloud, but it includes comparable cloud data platforms alongside the Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt and modelling work at the heart of this role.

Halden Pay's values of Together, Ownership and Pace—sharing context, taking responsibility, and reducing unnecessary complexity resonate with how I approach platform work: making systems easier to operate, sharing context with colleagues and building foundations that teams can rely on. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to the Data Platform team.

Kind regards,

Lena Varga-Holm